MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with experience owning CI/CD pipelines and automating test infrastructure for three product teams. Built short-lived merge-request environments using Helm and Kubernetes, and improved pipeline speed and reliability through parallelisation and dependency caching. Personal infrastructure projects include a k3s homelab with GitOps, monitoring and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure. Currently studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level experience), k3s, Argo CD
Infrastructure as code and automation: Terraform (personal project), Ansible (basic), Bash, Python
Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, GitLab API
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems and networking: Linux, Traefik ingress, TLS certificate automation with cert-manager
Languages: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL
Cloud learning: AWS fundamentals (EC2 and S3, personal learning); Hetzner VPS (personal project)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling pipelines, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; they are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 2%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and created Grafana dashboards to report flaky tests by team.
- Wrote an internal guide to the CI system used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications for client projects.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node k3s cluster using Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository through Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Automated deployment of a separate, short-lived environment for every merge request using GitLab CI and Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster.

- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against each environment.
- Configured automatic environment removal after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Supported teams in identifying recurring failures; the flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 2%.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation | Exam booked for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)